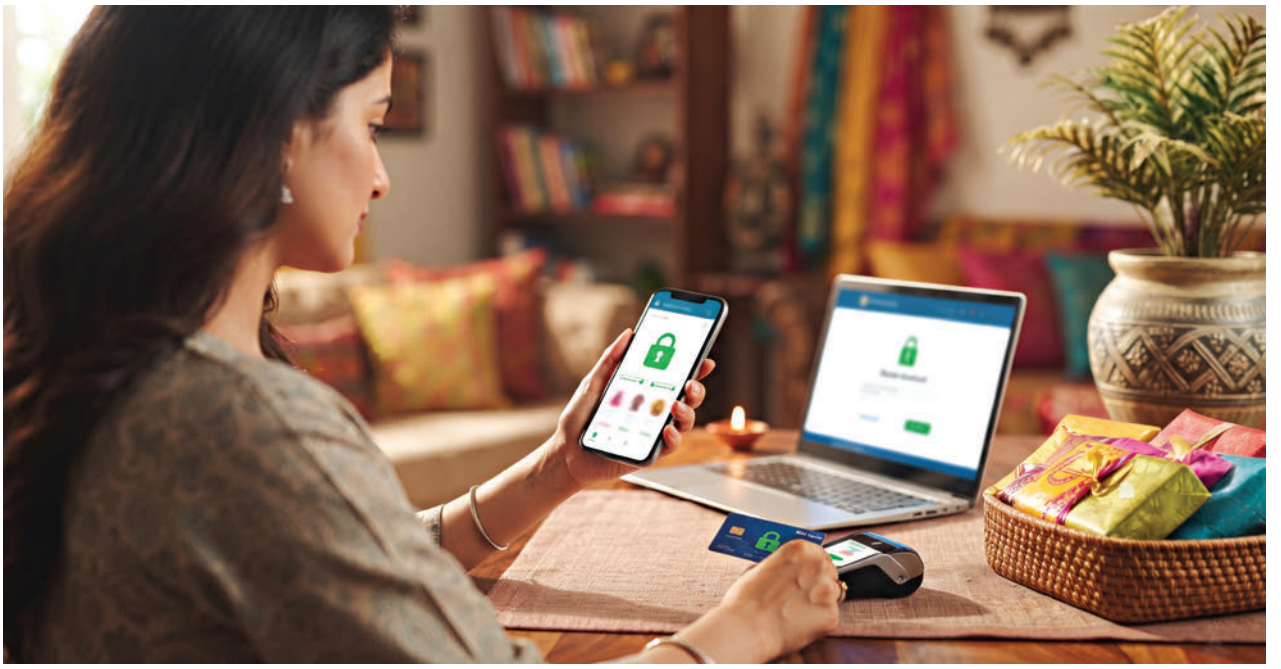


Indians play it safe at checkout

But aren't careful with links and passwords, reveal **Digit Research** findings

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Every festive season, the deals get bigger, and so do the traps laid around them. All through the month of September, we ran a reader survey on Digit.in which collected over 5,200 responses from readers across India, asking how they find deals, how they pay, how they protect their accounts, and whether they've had a brush with shopping fraud themselves.

The short version? Indian shoppers are surprisingly careful at the checkout, and surprisingly relaxed everywhere else. Cash on delivery is still the go-to safety net on unfamiliar sites, but password reuse, patchy two-factor authentication and a steady stream of forwarded deal links tell a very different story.

Paying on a new website

What do readers do when they land on a site or app they haven't used before? They hold on to their money until the parcel shows up. Nearly 48 percent said they usually pay cash on delivery on a new platform, almost three times as many as the next option.

UPI at checkout came a distant second at about 17 percent, followed by entering card details fresh each time at 14 percent and wallets or Buy Now Pay Later options at 12 percent. Saving card details on a new site for faster checkout was under 10 percent.

There's no two ways about it, COD is India's favourite trust filter. It isn't foolproof, since a fake store can still ship you a box of nothing, but it does keep your card and bank details away from a site you know nothing about.

Saved cards

That caution doesn't extend to the platforms readers know. Over 55 percent said they currently have card details saved on at least one shopping website or app, while 27 percent said they don't. Another 18 percent simply don't know whether they do.

Put that next to the previous finding and a clear pattern appears. Only about one in ten readers would save a